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AgileMind Discovery Session

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Attachments AgileMind Discovery Session

Meeting records *(Some recordings unavailable)*

Summary

Sales process and opportunity creation review focused on current inventory tracking and invoicing systems.

Sales Opportunity Tracking Process
The current process tracks programs under consideration, where print materials are manually tracked via separate sections to match contract quantities. It was confirmed that the sales team is not restricted from placing orders due to low stock, as inventory is managed manually by 1 person on the back end.

Inventory Management and Options
The meeting established that inventory is manually tracked and maintained in QuickBooks, not Salesforce, with QuickBooks chosen for inventory maintenance due to existing reporting and access. A major complication is mapping regional product variations with separate ISBNs, which requires significant manual oversight.

Multi-Year Agreements and Invoicing
An agreement is manually created in Salesforce when an opportunity is

closed won, which then leads to a manual invoice creation in QuickBooks. The major decision was made to build a configurable logic table in Salesforce to automate the lookup of the correct ISBN based on state and school, which will standardize inventory tracking in QuickBooks.

Next steps

- [ ] [Holly Wale] Document ISBN Logic: Compile current ISBN mapping logic into an Excel file. Use this data for system automation purposes.
- [ ] [kailash chanda] Finalize Process Scope: Develop the proposed integration flow diagram and detailed process overview documentation. Schedule a follow up meeting for Thursday to review the scope and finalize requirements.
- [ ] [Maria Gonzalez-Pettway, Abby Dawson, Crystal Robinson, Holly Wale] Review Flow Diagram: Review the flow diagram and overview documentation sent by Kailash. Provide feedback on any missing gaps or necessary changes before finalizing the scope.

Details

- **Sales Process and Opportunity Creation Overview**: Maria Gonzalez-Pettway proposed starting the discussion with the order process, beginning with salespeople creating opportunities and them converting into contracts, involving Abby Dawson and Crystal Robinson, with inventory as a mixed component. Abby Dawson presented the opportunity tracking process, which includes monitoring the amount, closed date, and programs considered; once an opportunity is marked as "closed won," an agreement is created. Kailash Chanda asked how products are added to build the order before sending out contracts.
- **Product and Print Media Tracking in Opportunities**: Abby Dawson explained that programs the customers are considering are tracked using a drag-and-drop feature for all offered programs. If customers are interested in print materials, such as student activity books, those are tracked in separate sections based on the courses being viewed, with quantities being entered manually to match the

contract or quote. Abby Dawson clarified that while products are typically online and print, sometimes only online access is purchased, and digital access is always included, with print being an add-on.

- **Inventory Checking and Order Placement Policy**: Kailash Chanda inquired about the process for checking inventory against print material orders, such as 150 copies, to confirm stock availability. Abby Dawson confirmed that they do not have a systematic way to check inventory at the time of order entry; Holly Wale tracks inventory manually. Holly Wale explained that orders are taken irrespective of current stock levels, especially for back-to-school season, as it is their job to ensure inventory exists before back-to-school distribution.
- **Inventory Management and Sales Team Restrictions**: Holly Wale confirmed that the sales team does not need to check inventory before placing orders; they can place the order, and the inventory is tracked separately to forecast demand and plan for production to ensure availability before school starts. The team does not want to implement a restriction at the order level to block sales due to low inventory, as this would be managed on the back end by Holly Wale and accounting, who would plan production based on the forecast. Exceptions, like large orders placed later in the year (e.g., January), are managed as one-offs, as they do not want to pass up a sale due to projected shortages.
- **Current Inventory System Location**: The meeting established that an inventory object currently does not exist within Salesforce. Abby Dawson and Holly Wale confirmed that Holly Wale manually manages the inventory and that the expected system for maintaining inventory is QuickBooks, where Maria Gonzalez-Pettway has already inputted the items. Maria Gonzalez-Pettway suggested that since orders start in Salesforce, and QuickBooks only handles invoicing and billing, Salesforce should ideally manage the inventory on hand, comparing it to opportunities to determine ordering needs, though they sought expertise on the best place for maintenance.
- **Inventory Maintenance Options and Proposal**: Kailash Chanda offered two options for inventory maintenance: either maintaining inventory in QuickBooks by subtracting the order quantity to create a deficit report for Holly Wale, or creating an inventory object in Salesforce and syncing it back from QuickBooks, which would require additional work. They noted that if Holly Wale is the only person accessing the inventory data, maintaining it in QuickBooks would be simpler. Maria Gonzalez-Pettway confirmed that QuickBooks has good reports, and Holly Wale has access to run them, making it acceptable to maintain inventory there.

- **Decision on Inventory Syncing to Salesforce**: Kailash Chanda clarified that because the sales team is not restricted from taking orders, they would not sync inventory back to Salesforce initially, maintaining inventory only in QuickBooks. Maria Gonzalez-Pettway expressed a belief that having the inventory data in Salesforce is beneficial for various reasons, including detailed reporting requirements for external partners. Kailash Chanda agreed that if beneficial, they would proceed with syncing the data to Salesforce.
- **Complexities of Inventory Mapping and Variant Handling**: Holly Wale introduced a complication: products often have multiple, region-specific variations (e.g., California vs. National versions) with separate International Standard Book Numbers (ISBNs) and inventory, while the opportunity only tracks a single item. Holly Wale noted that they use the mailing state to map the correct product version, but the process requires significant manual oversight due to numerous exceptions, such as specific titles being regional while others are national. Kailash Chanda suggested building a configurable logic table in Salesforce to automate the lookup of the correct ISBN based on state and school, which would then be used for inventory tracking in QuickBooks.
- **Agreement Creation and Manual Invoicing Process**: Abby Dawson explained that after an opportunity is closed won, Crystal Robinson manually creates an agreement. Crystal Robinson confirmed that once the agreement is created, it remains in draft mode until approved and is then used to create an invoice in QuickBooks. Maria Gonzalez-Pettway clarified that the action in QuickBooks is the creation of an invoice, not an order, based on the Salesforce agreement. The integration should automate this process: when an agreement is created in Salesforce, it will generate a new invoice in QuickBooks for an existing account.
- **Invoice Detail and Payment Tracking**: Crystal Robinson confirmed that they manually transfer the account details and line items to the QuickBooks invoice. After the QuickBooks invoice is created, Crystal Robinson manually updates the invoice number, date, and other payment information back into the Salesforce agreement using a custom field. The expectation for automation is to create a regular invoice in Salesforce, update the number, amount, dates, and track payment updates from QuickBooks to Salesforce, including the open balance. The follow-up date and escalation notes related to collections are expected to remain manual.
- **Handling Multi-Year Agreements (Prepaid)**: Crystal Robinson asked how multi-year agreements, especially invoicing, would be handled. Abby Dawson explained that for prepaid multi-year agreements, the full amount is contained in

the first opportunity, and subsequent years are set to zero. Holly Wale added that for inventory purposes, they only focus on the current year's needs, not the full term of the multi-year agreement. They track future year agreements using internal naming conventions (e.g., R27, R29) and close dates set to the relevant school year.

- **Multi-Year Inventory Planning and ISBN Challenges**: Holly Wale mentioned that they begin forecasting inventory needs for the back-to-school year in mid-January, with serious planning beginning in April. A challenge is that not all print inventory is reused, and if the ISBN changes for new inventory, a new logic needs to be implemented in the system. Kailash Chanda concluded that a logic must be put in place to standardize how new ISBNs are added and used to update inventory in QuickBooks, particularly for multi-year contracts, and this logic must be finalized before the solution is built.
- **Handling Multi-Year Agreements (Annual Payments)**: For multi-year agreements that are not prepaid, Abby Dawson explained that they are treated similarly to regular year-to-year opportunities; they are set at 90% and only "closed won" when the customer confirms they will submit payment for that year. Therefore, these contracts are handled as individual opportunities and agreements for each year's payment.
- **Contingency Planning for Inventory Anomalies**: Holly Wale raised concerns about on-the-fly changes and new titles that do not yet have ISBNs. Maria Gonzalez-Pettway acknowledged that anomalies will require some manual work, such as tracking new books until an ISBN is available. Kailash Chanda proposed creating a configurable table in Salesforce that the process would query to find the correct ISBN based on state and school, which could be updated by the team. If no ISBN is found, the system would mark the order for manual review.
- **Inventory Management System Location Reconfirmation**: Holly Wale expressed reservations about putting inventory in Salesforce, arguing it would create three systems and additional, potentially failure-prone layers when their primary problem—inventory valuation over time—is already tracked in QuickBooks. Kailash Chanda committed to creating a process flow diagram to share with Holly Wale for review and to schedule a follow-up call on Thursday to ensure the finalized scope addresses the needs of all teams.

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